



BRC Rope Tow Training Program

This document shall serve as the new guide in 2026 for the training structure pertaining to the operation of the Bogong Rover Chalet's Rope Tow.

Training Levels & Responsibilities

Tow Operator

- Responsible for completing start of week, start of day, end of day and end of week safety and operating checks.
- Responsible for ensuring compliance with BRC documentation, and national compliance with Rope Tow regulations and laws.
- Authorised to start the tow engine.
- Can carry out the responsibilities of the Tow Supervisor and Tow Trained User.
- Deliver the Tow and Tow Supervisor Training Briefs.
- Can hold the position of Tow Leader on a winter week, and is then subsequently authorised to provisionally train and promote Tow Operators.

Tow Supervisor

- Deliver the Tow Supervisor Training Briefing to upskill Tow Trained Users.
- Monitor the Tow Line for any hazards and incidents, report and activate the emergency stop if necessary.
- Coordinates 1st Aid responses as required.
- Can carry out the duties of the Tow Trained User.
- Mentors novice users in loading, safely riding and disembarking from tow rope.
- Supervises loading and unloading points.

Tow Trained User

- Use the rope tow in a safe manner.
- Report safety hazards and damage if sighted.

- Activate emergency stop systems if required.
- Can safely use a Nutcracker Lift Belt
- Has an awesome time.

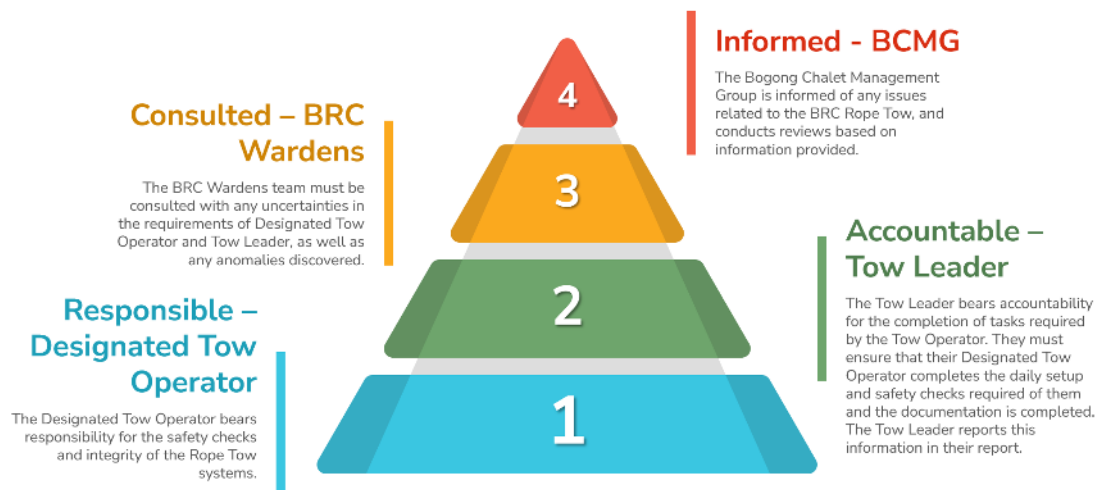
Tow Training Hierarchy

At-a-glance

Refer to *BRC Rope Tow Training Program* document



Hierarchy of Responsibility



Practical Positions on Winter Weeks

Tow Leader

- Designated by the BCMG prior to the winter party's commencement.
- Nominates the remaining practical positions as listed here to appropriately trained personnel, or delivers the training required to ensure all practical positions are filled.
- Completes the BRC Tow Leader Winter Week report.
- Ensures the BRC Rope Tow Logbook is completed by the Designated Tow Operator each operating day.
- **Must hold Tow Operator accreditation.**
- Typically delivers the *Tow Brief*. (Responsible for its completion in its entirety), alongside other Tow Operators.
- Can upskill Tow Supervisors to Tow Operators provisionally by providing the Tow Operator Briefing and subsequent physical training.

Designated Tow Operator

- Performs the duties of the Tow Operator for the period specified verbally by the Tow Leader and other operators.
- Completes the BRC Rope Tow Logbook for the period they are the Tow Operator if required.
- Carries a radio.

Designated Tow Supervisors

- One remains at each operational loading or unloading point,, monitoring the slope for safety incidents.
- Mentors novice users in loading, safely riding and disembarking from tow rope.
- Assesses Tow Users and nominates them as Trained Tow Users when they have mastered Trained tow user competence.
- Activates the emergency stop system if required.
- Carries a radio.

Trained Users

- Ski the rope tow in a safe manner.

- Can competently load and unload.
- Does not fall off the tow regularly

Training Requirements for Transition

Tow Operator

- Be a winter party member at the BRC.
- Has physically demonstrated competence and understanding of systems and procedures.
- Has read the *Tow Operator Training Brief* found below.
- Currently holds the Tow Supervisor training level.
- Be endorsed by the Tow Leader and approved by the BRC Warden.
 - May be provisionally appointed by the Tow Leader.
- Must be 18 years old.

Tow Supervisor

- Be a winter party member at the BRC.
- Physical demonstrated competence and understanding of safety procedures.
- Read the *Tow Supervisor Training Brief* found below.
- Currently hold the Tow Trained User training level.
- Be endorsed by a Tow Supervisor.
- Must be 18 years old.
- Must be a competent skier/snowboarder.
- Must hold at least 1 hour of tow usage experience.

Tow Trained User

- Receive the *Tow Brief*.
- Demonstrate physical competency with Rope Tow safety systems and procedures.
- Be a winter party member at the BRC.

- Must have basic skiing/snowboarding ability.

Training Materials

Tow Operator Training Brief

- Tow Operators must not under any circumstances make modifications or adjustments outside those described for normal operations to the tow system without explicit authorisation from the BRC Off-Mountain Maintenance Contact.
- The rope tow must never be used until the start of week and start of day checks have been conducted and signed off in the BRC Rope Tow Logbook.
- The roller door to the hut must be open during all tow hut engine usage.
- Practical training components:
 - Setting the rope on the bull wheel and drive wheel.
 - Setting the rope on the hook above the road.
 - Setting up all required legislative signage.
 - Checking the tow motor fluids prior to operation.
 - Completing the BRC Rope Tow Logbook.
 - Checking the E-Stop system.
 - Clearing/preparing a dismounting zone.
 - Setting the safety gate for effective use.
 - Operating the Rope Tow controls.
 - Safety checks prior to engine restart during regular operations.

Tow Supervisor Training Brief

The Tow Supervisor position specifically involves monitoring for incidents and reacting in a timely manner.

- Tow Supervisors sit at the top of the tow slope. They maintain an **active** watch on users and assists with unloading where required.
- Supervising new tow users and placing a priority watch on them is important. The rope tow is a great way for inexperienced skiers to practise with reduced physical exertion, but they are more prone to self injury which may require system shutdown.

- Only registered winter party members are to use the BRC Rope Tow. The Rope Tow must be shut down immediately if unauthorised users attempt to use the rope tow, and the Wardens team notified immediately..
- If a whistle blow is heard, the tow **should not** be shut down immediately, as this may inhibit assistance from reaching the person blowing the whistle. Assess before shutdown.
- Any safety incidents must be followed up post-operations to ensure a report is completed.

Tow Brief

A rope tow safety briefing is to be conducted in the presence of the entire party prior to the first use of the Rope Tow for the week. It is recommended that this briefing be given at the post-morning duties parade on the morning of the likely first day of use of the rope tow for the week. The rope tow briefing is to be given by the designated Rope Tow Leader for the week, or someone delegated as competent by the Rope Tow Leader. The following points shall be covered/relayed:

1. What is a rope tow?
 - a. Participants should log experience in their personal logbooks.
2. Nutcracker attachment belt technical information and practises.
 - a. Safe storage of the nutcracker device on the attachment belt while skiing in order to prevent injury when falling - tucked into the side of the hip.
 - b. The failsafe aspect and nuance/method of using the nutcracker attachment belt, emphasising “it is okay to just let go”.
 - c. How to navigate the rope sheaves and other obstacles while riding the tow (just guide the nutcracker through it).
 - d. “Unapproved harnesses or use of damaged nutcracker harnesses is strictly prohibited on the BRC Rope Tow”
3. “There is a requirement under BRC policy for all BRC Rope Tow Users to ski in control at all times and not conduct themselves in such a manner that poses any hazard to others.”
 - a. The importance and strict requirement of buddy system skiing in fringe terrain.
 - b. Rope Tow skiing areas that are suitable for beginners.
 - c. Keep an eye out and assist less experienced skiers and tow users where possible.

4. The correct and safe methods of mounting and dismounting the rope tow.
 - a. Mounting and Dismounting zones on the tow.
 - b. Tow Supervisors must ensure that until the previous person loaded gets at least one pole ahead, another person cannot be loaded.
5. The daily Rope Tow Safety brief and what it means. (Actually discuss the report of the day!)
 - a. Also including who the Tow Operators and Supervisors are that day.
6. "Helmets are not mandatory for usage of the BRC Rope Tow. Despite this, helmet usage is recommended while using the tow. This is in line with current practices at other ski fields operating a nutcracker ski tow.
7. Names of all BRC rope tow users are to be recorded on the main whiteboard in the BRC dining room prior to usage.
8. Carrying of Whistles by all tow users is mandatory, and this must be checked before users are allowed to ride the tow.
 - a. 3 blasts for an emergency.
 - b. Whistles are not to be used as a communication tool in non-emergency situations.
9. Only registered winter party participants are to use the rope tow.
10. "All safety incidents involving the rope tow must be recorded in alignment with the BRC standard practices."
11. Use of the Emergency Stop systems on the BRC rope tow.
12. Tow Supervisor and Tow Operator roles and how these designated people work.
 - a. The rope tow controls are not to be operated by any persons who do not hold the Tow Operator training level.
 - b. The rope tow will never be operated until all weekly and daily checks have been completed, logged and signed off by the designated Tow Operator.
 - c. "The rope tow is specifically designed to comply with the standards set under Australian Law through the Canadian CSA Z98-2019 Rope Tow Standards."
 - d. Carriage of radios by users is recommended, and the Designated Tow Operator will organise this.
 - i. At least one other radio must be used apart from the permanently installed Tow Hut one.

- ii. It is further recommended that all Designated Tow Supervisors have a radio at all times.
- 13. When skiing the fringe terrain or beyond (marked red and then clear on the map), a minimum of 4 tow skiers applies, and the buddy system must be observed. When skiing in the unbounded (clear on map) area, a Trip Intention Form must be completed.
 - a. Tow Supervisors must also be put in place at each loading and unloading station.
- 14. Maximum 6 Rope Tow riders (using the tow itself) at any given time.